



During an appearance on news outlet *Euractiv's* 'The Tech Brief' podcast, Van Huffelen stated that The Netherlands has reached an agreement on the usage of open source in most or all components of a digital ID wallet.

Everyone involved in a digital wallet programme gains trust as a result of the transparency. The software is superior to closed source programmes since anybody may access the source code and make changes. Open source software may be safer for the same reason. According to van Huffelen, it is also more effective. She said that she "believes in not being super-naïve," echoing decades of prior justifications for open source.

Microsoft Research open sources Project FarmVibes

In an effort to increase farmers' yields while lowering costs and assisting the agriculture sector in accepting responsibility for its role in climate change, Microsoft Research is open sourcing its agricultural data and networking technology. The technology platform, known as Project FarmVibes, incorporates the cloud provider's most recent research in precision and sustainable agriculture, according to a blog post by Microsoft's Jake Siegel. This builds on data analysis and integration work done with Microsoft's clients like Land O' Lakes and Bayer.



The algorithms are intended to serve as a decision-making tool at each stage of farming, from sowing the seeds through reaping the harvest. According to Siegel, this involves forecasting temperature and wind speeds, determining the ideal depth to plant seeds based on soil conditions, advising on crop types, and following best practices to keep carbon sequestered in the soil. It also involves determining the right amount of fertiliser or herbicide to use on which areas of the fields.

The artificial intelligence (AI) component of Microsoft's FarmVibes project includes features like Async Fusion, which combines sensors and satellite imagery to create maps of soil moisture and nutrient heat; SpaceEye, which uses AI to remove clouds from satellite imagery; DeepMC, which uses sensor data and weather forecasts to predict the temperatures and wind speeds of a farm's microclimate, and a "what if" analysis tool that speculates on how farming practices might change.

Andrew Nelson, a fifth-generation farmer and software engineer, has tested the Project FarmVibes suite on a 7,500-acre farm under his management. Nelson collaborated with Microsoft Research to evaluate the technology portfolio. He said that the project's AI will improve damage control capabilities while also saving him time and money in agricultural settings.

Nelson is now piloting FarmVibes. Connect, which will utilise the unused TV white space spectrum to provide internet connectivity to rural and remote locations. He is also experimenting with FarmVibes.Edge to cleverly compress the enormous volumes of data collected by drones. This approach helps to focus on one specific problem, such as weeds in a field, while ignoring other issues.

Microsoft intends to open source additional FarmVibes parts related to edge and connectivity services in the future, in addition to the AI.

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